

vertigo!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 658 July 2003 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House,¹ on the first clear Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher² at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up. Meetings, now run by new President and reality TV star Nigel Roberts, start at 8.00 pm with club business. Talks commence at 8.01 pm.



Section night: July 7th: “Happy Khampas in the Tibetan Green Belt” A Nank/”Bam Bam” tag team:

Let's hear John Nankervis again on this: “hmmm...yes...argghhh...the topic for Dave “Bam Bam” Bamford's [NZ Alpine Club Pres.] and my talk in July was all news to us. Not easily talked about, y'know, without all listeners signing compulsory *confidentiality agreements* with the law firm I'm currently a partner in for \$1000 a pop, to fund my...ahem... future trips. We'd prefer something like "Kazakhs and Khampas - Exploratory Climbing in the Mongolian Altai and Tibet's Green Belt". Sounds good!



Alan, Chitty & Nicky en route to Mt Pollux, April 2003

¹ On Bowen Street, squashed behind the Treasury on Number 1 the Terrace.

² On Molesworth Street, opposite Parliament.



Section nights: Upcoming:

August 4th Dick Price

A man who knows more about mountain medicine than all of us laid end on end will talk about aspects of his mountain days, including his ascent of Everest and his recommended tool for amputation of frost bitten toes - a can opener. Respect!

September 1st Short Talks Night

Section Members tell us what they've been up to recently

October 6th Lydia Bradey: Hold your breath!

The first woman to climb Mt Everest without oxygen (i.e. holding *her* breath) will give us an insight into why people have found Mongolia such a beautiful destination



Section trips news: Growing and sowing

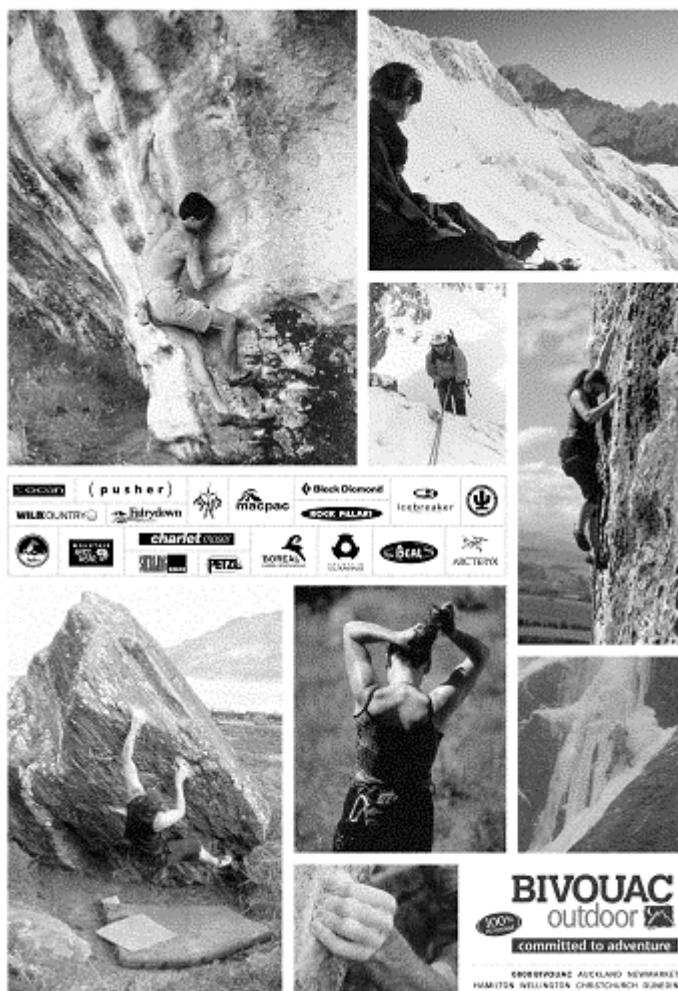
Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories, tall or short, fat or thin, sharp or dim. We love to know what you're up to!

And this just off the wires... Mt Tappy Trip report – Her Majesty's Birthday Weekend 2003

This was a "medium" 3-day trip with the intention of having a leisurely adventure climbing Mt Tappy over QB weekend. Our group of 8 were mixed with most having done the AIC or an equivalent course and some other climbs in the past 2-3 years. We even let a token rock climber come along! We weren't anywhere near Olympic class level but we were all adventurers.

Access was pretty good, and we spent the 1st and 3rd days going up/down the Hodder River to stay in the Hodder Huts. Even though we had to cross the river 66 times on the way up it was never more than knee deep, and the sun was shining on a windless day. Paul was the 1st to slip over and got to wear the Alpine woolly jersey award. But not for long as yours truly had a spectacular face plant (well I wanted to keep my pack dry). It took us 6 hours to get to the huts.

Sunday dawned clear but breezy with a 30-40 km/h westerly and we were on our way with a leisurely 7.30am start at sunrise. Two others from Wellington/Blenheim (Geoff and Quentin) joined us under their own steam. Paul returned early on after deciding it probably wasn't a good idea to damage the pristine environment with a dose of his 'flu. There was little snow to be seen so that the trail was easy to follow up Staircase stream and around and between the bluffs and semi-frozen waterfalls. In the upper valley the trail petered out



in steep, slippery scree at the halfway point. But that was OK as we had a great time (NOT!) getting bluffed out and backtracking down 30-50m! One of our 2 rookies (Chris) decided at that point that was quite enough experience for one-day and returned.

At 2300m we finally came upon some snow and out came the crampons, only to be stripped off when the snow ran out at 2600m as we acquired the main ridge. Yes folks, between us we carried 20kg of ice axes and crampons over 45km, to use them for less than 1 hour on 300m of snow where we could find it! 20% cover at best.

It was now 12.45pm, we had climbed over 1100m from the huts and we still had an hour to go. The wind on the ridge was strong, 60-80km/h, difficult to stand in let alone climb. It seemed likely darkness would overtake us

on the descent. At this point the climb changed from an adventure to a mission, all but one of us (Kate) dropped our packs and raced to the summit, bagging it in a 35-minute rush. The trip down was quick and uneventful, what took 6 hours to ascend was just 3 hours to return. A pretty cool day.

Knocking back a few beers over dinner in Blenheim on Monday night was pretty good too.

Stats: age range 30-50, 38% female, 63% parents, minimum T = 5.6C (summit). Team Members = Kevin Patterson (leader), Maria Cunningham, Kevin Martin, Tom Zink, Sean Kelly, Chris Kroger, Kate Smith, and Paul Clark. In addition Geoff Keey, and Quentin. 7 out of 10 summited.



New Zealand Alpine Journal 2003: Contributions please!

Contributions sought... Yup — it's that time of the year again; time to put pen to paper, fingers to keyboard and start sorting out those slides.

We want *your* words and photos. Principally we seek reports of this year's most note-worthy climbs (either new climbs or repeats), articles or essays from any aspect of the greater sphere of climbing, local area reports, and yes... obituaries. As always photographs and artwork are welcomed.

If you have an idea you wish to discuss or any questions, or a submission, don't hesitate to contact the editor:

Mark Watson – NZAJ Editor
(day) 03 377 7595, (eve) 03 942 3312
editor@alpineclub.org.nz
PO Box 786, Christchurch.

CLOSING DATE 1st SEPT 2003

Our website

- Check out our web site: www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz !
- Join the email discussion group!
- New photos and trip reports up!

Congratulations to the budding Cartier-Bresson's, or Section photo comp results

The Wellington section's annual photo competition was held on Monday, 9 June, and contained a veritable feast of eye-smacking photographs. Eighty-two pictures were entered in the competition, and the winning photographers were:

- STEVE EASTWOOD in the Alpine General category (for a stunning early morning shot of a golden Mt Rolleston)
- DAVE MORGAN in the Alpine Activity category (for a hauntingly evocative silhouette of four climbers during a drink stop on a glacier)
- TONY GATES in the Alpine Nature category (for a remarkable close-up of beady-eyed kea)
- PETE MCGREGOR in the Rock Climbing category for an action shot of a boulderer losing his grip)
- TONY GATES in the Photo Journalism category (for a candid shot of two exhausted participants - including our own Eric Duggan - in this year's Tararua mountain race)
- PETE MCGREGOR in the Humour category (for a picture entitled "I told you bum sliding was a bad idea!")

In addition, Honours photos were submitted by Karen Domaneschi, Michele Domaneschi, Merewyn Ellis, Garth London, Pete McGregor, Dave Morgan, and Bruce Roberts, while Andy Maloney won an honourable mention for a trio of good-humoured slides.

New edition of the Whanganui Bay guide by Len Gillman – A review

So the new Whanganui Bay guide's out. Great! I need it! First thought - fantastic new colour photo on the cover. I want it, I buy it! It's going to be great! I open the covers. A huge disappointment strikes. Inside remains the same old functionalist Bay guide minimally updated with a modicum of new climbs where necessary. The few new topos seem lower in quality than the old ones.

If you don't have a guide to the Bay, this one, like the old out of print edition, will do the basics okay. Buy it and use it. It'll get you to the bottom of the climb and ensure you'll take up the right number of quick draws up with you.

The insides remain a drab set of notes. The quality of guides has moved up a notch since last century (think Mentz and Tempest's Arapiles or Grampians guides for state of the art) and this new edition ain't kept pace. It hasn't even tried. Where's the richness of climbing, and in particular the richness of climbing at the Bay? I would have liked a bit of social history of the major characters, events, and climbs, and stories behind the names of the climbs. I would have liked some relevant history of the community of people who live at the Bay. I would have liked to know about the changing nature of the relationships between locals and climbing community over the years. What's the future for new climbing at the Bay?

If you do already have the old edition, ask the question: is it worth coughing up thirty five bucks for to find the location of a few new climbs that you didn't know about?

Maybe next time the guide might move beyond what is virtually a re-print.

Editor.



CHAIRPERSON'S QUIZ No. 2

After the interest shown in the 5 May section-night quiz question (which was "Where was Ed Hillary on 5 May 1953?"), the section's new chairperson, Nigel Roberts, posed another quiz question at the June section-night meeting.

Inspired by a book he's recently bought about the 50 USA state summits (which range from a 345 feet / 105 metre pimple in Florida to the 20,320 feet / 6,194 metre Denali in Alaska), Nigel is now offering another bottle of wine. (In May it was Shingle Peak, this time it's Jackman Ridge!) The prize will go to the person who submits the first correct answer that's opened after the 5 July 2003 closing date of the competition.

The question is: What are the six Australian state summits? (Name the peaks and the states).

Either email your answers to <nr@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz> or send them by snail mail to Nigel Roberts, 2 Gloucester Street, Wilton, Wellington 6005. Remember, your answers must reach Nigel by noon on Saturday, 5 July 2003.

The winner will be announced and the wine handed over at the 7 July section-night meeting.

NZAC National Instruction Programme

Course Numbers are limited so book early! Fully qualified alpine guides or rock instructors will be used to lead all courses and there will be an instructor - student ration of 1:4 ensuring an excellent learning environment.

Intermediate Alpine Instruction (Two Days) \$130

12-13 July The Remarkables, Otago

16-17 July Fox Glacier, Westland

19-20 July Mt Ruapehu

2-3 August Mt Ruapehu

Intermediate Rock Instruction (Two Days) \$99

23-24 October, Otago

1-2 November, Canterbury

23-24 October, Auckland

1-2 November, Wellington

Intermediate- Advanced Mountaineering (Five Days) \$750

3-7 January 2004, Unwin Hut Mt Cook

10-14 January 2004 Unwin Hut Mt Cook

Richard Wesley, National Administrator

Phone: 03 377 7595

Email: richard@alpineclub.org.nz

 WELLINGTON . AUCKLAND	Shed 6 Queens Wharf Wellingtons Waterfront Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896 wn@fergskayaks.co.nz www.fergskayaks.co.nz Open 7 Days Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8. Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.
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And here are the club trips...

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, come and chat to either Jenny Henshaw or Mike Williams.

Jenny (alpinetrips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) is the person to contact about alpine trips and Mike (rocktrips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) can help you out with planning rock climbing trips.

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going on a safe and enjoyable trip.

See you in the hills!

Trips currently on the calendar...

Ruapehu Ice Climbing	<i>Weekend July 19-20</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Ice Climbing	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Peat, email: mike.peat@xtra.co.nz , 04 479 5521 (h)	
Climbing steep ice / mixed routes at Whakapapa, there are plenty of brilliant routes near the ski field that are rarely climbed. Suitable for climbers that have previous experience leading on rock and some alpine experience that want to take the next step. Maximum 6 people, expect heart-pounding action!	

Whangaehu Ski-Touring	<i>Weekend August 2-3</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Ski Touring	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Peat, email: mike.peat@xtra.co.nz , 04 479 5521 (h)	
Based from the club hut, intermediate skiing ability required - and lots of enthusiasm.	

Ruapehu Alpine Style!!	<i>Weekend August 30-31</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Peat, email: mike.peat@xtra.co.nz , 04 479 5521 (h)	
Access the bush edge via 4WD from the south, climb the spur to the west of the Wahianoa River, camp on the Glacier and traverse Girdlestone, Tahurangi and Mitre. Suitable for last years AIC students or anyone who hasn't explored this remote part of the mountain. A good level of fitness is required.	

Ski Touring Traverse of Ruapehu	<i>Weekend September 13-14</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Ski Touring	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate
<i>Organiser:</i> Michele Domaneschi, email md@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
Dust off those old skis, and head for the hills with Michele and friends, to explore the crater area of Ruapehu, crossing from Whakapapa to Turoa. More details to follow.	

Girdlestone	<i>Weekend September 20-21</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Alpine, Various	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> TBC, email alpinetrips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
The plan is to split into small groups and do various activities (weather and conditions dependent), e.g., North ridge of Girdlestone/South West face of Girdlestone (technical route), Tahurangi summit, ice-fall climbing, snow boarding or skiing, or the climbing wall at National Park! We aim to be based at the Massey University ski hut, 25mins from Ohakune.	

Wharepapa Rock Climbing	<i>Weekend September 27 – 28</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock Climbing	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A weekend away rock climbing at Wharepapa in the central North Island.	

Taranaki Ice Climbing	<i>Weekend October 4-5</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Ice Climbing	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A chance to get up to the summit or ice climb on some of the crags near Taurangi Lodge. Participants need to be at least post AIC level as this is not a novice trip.	

Arthurs Pass / Castle Hill Exploration	<i>Long Weekend October 25-26-27</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock / Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A trip with everything, the plan involves a mix of rock climbing at Castle Hill and Flock Hill, and day trips with mountaineering objectives such as Rolleston, Phipps, or possibly a 2 dayer to Franklin. Details depend on ambitions and abilities in the group. Trip to be based at NZAC hut in Arthurs Pass Village.	

Aoraki / Mt Cook National Park	<i>Long Weekend October 25-26-27</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Jenny Henshaw, email jh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
An extended long weekend, probably involving one day off work, with the aim of climbing either Mt Dixon from the Plateau area, or the Minarets, from the Tasman Valley. Details to follow.	

Paynes Ford	<i>Weekend November 8-9</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock / Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A weekend to the top-o-the-south, rock climbing at Paynes Ford.	

Tasman Saddle	<i>Week November 29- December 7</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Caroline Duggan, email cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz Garth London, email gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
Get in quick if you're keen for a trip to Tasman Saddle. Objectives are a plenty and great company is guaranteed. This trip will be limited in number and based on a first in, first served principle. There are currently a few spaces left, after that its onto the waiting list.	

Hopkins Valley	<i>Week January 3 – 11, 2004</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering / Rock	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A week away from the tourist hoards, exploring this great area just south of Cook/Aoraki, with tramping and easy summits through to cragging and snowy mountains.	

Taranaki Rock Trip	<i>Long weekend January 17-18-19</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock Climbing	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> TBC email rocktrips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	

Other Trips...

Nepal	<i>TBC</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
How about a slightly longer trip to Nepal in October/November 2004?? Several people have indicated interest in a section climbing trip to attempt several trekking peaks - Island Peak and Lubuje East have been suggested as reasonably straightforward objectives. This could include a non-climbing trek party also. *Update*: Interest in this trip steadily grows. With the changing regulations so too do the objectives, one of which is to scale Mt Have-a-Good-Time. Trekking options will be part of this trip. We will be aiming to stay away from the Everest circus while still utilising the ease of logistics. One of our goals will be an unclimbed peak up to 6500m. People who are interested and willing to be part of a team effort can contact Steve Hart.	

Chile	<i>TBC</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Toto Gronlund, toto.high@ntl-world.com	
The English alpine club are organising a trip to Patagonia in 2004, if you would like more information, contact Toto Gronlund.	



Thanks to **Garth** for organising the Photo Competition entries and prizes and **Nigel** for judging!!!

The substitute Sub-Editor.



for sale

Open to offers on all items

- Fischer Cornice Skis, 195cm, with Salomon 555 bindings. Learner to intermediate grade ski's, not bad condition. \$40
- Atomic Pro 140cm skis with Salomon 447 bindings \$50 - good for kids
- Rossignol Atoll ski's, 175cm, with Look GT bindings \$30
- Fischer Futura Super skis with old plate bindings, 160cm. \$20
- Fischer ceramics, SL4 Mirage ski's, 175 cm. Good looking ski's.\$50
- San Marco touring ski boots. Size 8.5>9 \$10.
- Climbing boot gaiters, fleece lined, wire attachment around boot sole. \$15
- Assorted flippers and wetsuit bits
- Homemade showshoes based on American bear claw model. 2 pairs, one not finished but all parts there \$30 ea.
- 4 assorted rock climbing chocks and wedges and 3 solid galv-iron ice screws \$10 each. Not used.
- Ice hammer, Stubai, wooden shaft. \$30.

Nick Miller

Tel 04 5687943

1/50 Udy St, Petone



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Come down and see us for all your climbing and bouldering needs. We have heaps of good routes from grade 14 through to 30. We have the only bouldering room in Wellington, which we have just enlarged to help aspiring and existing climbers become STRONGER.

Remember that it only costs NZAC members \$8.00 to climb with ID, and you get 20% off all climbing gear that you purchase from us. If we don't have what you want we will get it.

Climbers helping climbers

HangDog and Top Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181



Wellington Section Directory: 2003 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron	Judy Reid	N/A	N/A
Chairperson	Nigel Roberts	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> NR	(04) 475 7543
Vice Chairpersons	Pete De Joux	PDJ <i>or</i> PD	(04) 478 1017
	Steve Hart	SH	N/A
Secretary	Rachael Schmidt	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RS	(04) 470 4479
Treasurer	Caroline Duggan	TREASURER <i>or</i> CD	(04) 475 5542
National Representatives	Maria Cassidy	MC	N/A
	Caroline Duggan	CD	(04) 475 5542
Instruction: AIC	Pete de Joux	AIC	(04) 478 1017
Instruction: RIC	Scott Taylor	SPRINGROCK	N/A
Trips: Alpine	Jenny Henshaw	ALPINETRIPS <i>or</i> JH	N/A
Trips: Rock	Mike Williams	ROCKTRIPS <i>or</i> MW	(04) 973 2995
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Lynn Ayers	LA	(04) 977 4914
	Maria Cassidy	MC	N/A
	Michele Domaneschi	MD	N/A
	Jenny Henshaw	JH	N/A
	Garth London	GL	(04) 479 2984
	Alan Lowrie	AL	N/A
	Mike O'Brien	MOB	(04) 380 0913
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
	Mike Williams	MW	(04) 973 2995
National President	Dave Bamford	DB	N/A
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Section Night Admin	Kara Lipski	KL	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A

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